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CALL OF DUTY Mona Singh and Barun Sobti in *Kohrra 2*

Fog of **Death**

Kohrra is returning on Netflix for what promises to be a gripping second season

When Punjab-set crime drama *Kohrra* came out on Netflix in 2023, it was loved by audiences and critics alike. For creator and showrunner Sudip Sharma, it was "a self-contained story" and if there wasn't an additional season, he wouldn't have been miffed. But Sudip and his writers couldn't resist a second go when the opportunity came. "[Given our] love for Punjab...and the characters and their relationship dynamics, we felt there was more to explore."

Unlike season two of his other acclaimed show, *Paatal Lok* (2025), which shifted locale and was set in Nagaland, Sudip was certain that *Kohrra* would stick to Punjab. "I can't see *Kohrra* in any other place, it's as much a character," says Sudip, who also takes on directing duties in the new season.

Punjab, the character, returns, as does police inspector Garundi (Barun Sobti). But Balbir Singh (Suvinder Vicky, pitch perfect) is replaced with inspector Dhanwant Kaur (Mona Singh). The introduction of a female protagonist brings a change in relationship dynamics. "It starts on a frosty note, [but] eventually finds its way to respect and a sense of fraternity," says Sudip of the arc. "By the end of six episodes, you will have a smile on your face."

Barun and Mona were certainly smiling while making the show. For Barun, *Kohrra* was both a homecoming and a source of elation and liberation, helping him evolve as an actor. "It's a different show altogether, far more audacious and shocking—Garundi is a different character," he adds. Mona was elated to join a celebrated show, one she was an ardent fan of. With *Kohrra,* she becomes the latest actress to don the khaki on streaming. "Being a woman cop in a man's world, that too in Punjab, is not easy," she says. "You have to prove your worth."

The trio now awaits the audience's verdict on February 11 to see if they get to return to the foggy fields of Punjab again. ■

—Suhani Singh

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The audience at the Mahindra Blues Festival *is so attentive and engaged that international artists readily return to play the event. Four of the six main acts at its 14th instalment, which will take place on February 14 and 15, have performed before. Here's what you need to know about this year's line-up:*

1. SHEMEKIA COPELAND

The electric blues singer from the US, who played the *MBF* in 2011 and 2017, will take its stage for the third time. Nine years on, she's amassed four more Grammy nominations (of a total of seven), including two for her 2024 full-length effort *Blame It On Eve*, which won Album of the Year at the Blues Music Awards. Based on her recent concerts, we can expect songs from that release as well as a mix of tracks from her extensive discography that dates back to her 1998 debut LP *Turn Up The Heat*.



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